

ESSENTIAL GRAMMAR

Tenses

TENSE or STRUCTURE	FORM Positive	Negative	Question	USE For ...
Present simple	I/You/We/They work. He/She/It works.	I/You/We/They do not (don't) work. He/She/It does not (doesn't) work.	Do I/you/we/they work? Does he/she/it work?	- facts and states - habits and repeated actions - future use to talk about timetabled events - after time clauses (<i>when, before, as soon as, after, until</i>)
Present continuous	I am ('m) working. He/She/It is ('s) working. You/We/They are ('re) working.	I am ('m) not working. He/She/It is ('s) not working. You/We/They are ('re) not working.	Am I working? Is he/she/it working? Are you/we/they working?	- actions happening now - temporary situations - future use, to talk about planned events or arrangements
Present perfect simple	I/You/We/They have ('ve) worked. He/She/It has ('s) worked.	I/You/We/They have not (haven't) worked. He/She/It has not (hasn't) worked.	Have I/you/we/they worked? Has he/she/it worked?	- present situations that started in the past - past experiences, without specifying exactly when they took place
Present perfect continuous	I/You/We/They have ('ve) been working. He/She/It has ('s) been working.	I/You/We/They have not (haven't) been working. He/She/It has not (hasn't) been working.	Have I/you/we/they been working? Has he/she/it been working?	- repeated actions that affect the present - a recent repeated activity that is relevant now - an explanation for something by referring to a past action / event
Past simple	I/You/He/She/It/We/They worked.	I/You/He/She/It/We/They did not (didn't) work.	Did I/you/he/she/it/we/they work?	- completed actions or past events - repeated past actions - past states
Past continuous	I/He/She/It was working. You/We/They were working.	I/He/She/It was not (wasn't) working. You/We/They were not (weren't) working.	Was I/he/she/it working? Were you/we/they working?	- actions in progress at a specific time in the past - past actions interrupted by other actions
Past perfect simple	I/You/He/She/It/We/They had ('d) worked.	I/You/He/She/It/We/They had not (hadn't) worked.	Had I/you/he/she/it/we/they worked?	states or actions that happened before other events in the past
Past perfect continuous	I/You/He/She/It/We/They had ('d) been working.	I/You/He/She/It/We/They had not (hadn't) been working.	Had I/you/he/she/it/we/they been working?	states or actions that continued up until other events in the past
used to	I/You/He/She/It/We/They used to work.	I/You/He/She/It/We/They did not (didn't) use to work.	Did I/you/he/she/it/we/they use to work?	past habits or situations that are no longer true in the present
would for past habits	I/You/He/She/It/We/They would ('d) work.	I/You/He/She/It/We/They would not (wouldn't) work.	Would I/you/he/she/it/we/they work?	past habits or situations that are no longer true in the present
will for future use	I/You/He/She/It/We/They will ('ll) work.	I/You/He/She/It/We/They will not (won't) work.	Will I/you/he/she/it/we/they work?	- making predictions or giving opinions about the future - spontaneous decisions
be going to for future use	I am ('m) going to work. He/She/It is ('s) going to work. You/We/They are ('re) going to work.	I am ('m) not going to work. He/She/It is ('s) not going to work. You/We/They are ('re) not going to work.	Am I going to work? Is he/she/it going to work? Are you/we/they going to work?	- predictions based on evidence - plans and intentions
Future continuous	I/You/He/She/It/We/They will ('ll) be working.	I/You/He/She/It/We/They will not (won't) be working.	Will I/you/he/she/it/we/they be working?	future actions that take place over a period of time or future actions that have already been planned
Future perfect	I/You/He/She/It/We/They will ('ll) have worked.	I/You/He/She/It/We/They will not (won't) have worked.	Will I/you/he/she/it/we/they have worked?	future actions we expect to be finished by a certain time in the future